

Fragments

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Functional English(Theory)

Overview

1. Fragments

2. Run-Ons

Fragment

A word group that lacks a subject or a verb and does not express a complete thought is known as fragment.

1. Dependent-word fragment
2. -ing and to fragments
3. added-detail fragments
4. missing-subject fragments

Dependent-word Fragment

Some group words that begin with a dependent word like after, although, because etc. are called dependent-word fragment

Because there was a mosquito in the room. I could not fall asleep.



Correcting Dependent-word Fragment

Attach it to the sentence before or after it

Because there was a mosquito in the room, I could not fall asleep.

I could not fall asleep because there was a mosquito in the room.

Eliminate the dependent word

There was a mosquito in the room.

-ing and to Fragments

When an -ing word appears at or near the start of a word group, a fragment result. These fragments often lack a subject and part of the verb.

I spent almost two hours on the phone yesterday. trying to find a garage to repair my car. eventually i had to have it towed to a garage in another town.

Correcting -ing Fragments

Attach to the sentence that comes before/after it.

I spent almost 2 hours on the phone yesterday, trying to find a garage to repair my car.(non-example on pg.36)

Add a subject and place -ing form with correct verb form.

She did not realize until a week later that the car averaged seven miles per gallon of gas (non-example on pg 36)

Change being to verb be (am, are, is, was, were).

It was the only time he could sit unbothered.(non-example on pg.36)

Correcting to Fragments

Add the to fragment by adding it to the preceding sentence.

I plan on working overtime to get this job finished. (non-example is on pg. 37).

Added detailed Fragments

They lack subject and a verb.

I love to cook Italian. Especially spaghetti and lasagna. I make everything from scratch.

Correcting Added detail Fragments

Attach to the sentence that comes before it.

I love to cook Italian, especially spaghetti and lasagna.

Add a subject and a verb to make it complete.

The class often starts late. For example, yesterday it began at a quarter after nine

Change words to make it a part of preceding sentence.

Among the courses he failed before he earned his degree were English, Economics and Business.

Missing-Subject Fragments

With the exception of imperative sentences (commands), if a sentence is missing a subject then it is a missing-subject fragment.

The truck skidded on the rain-slick highway. But missed a telephone pole on the side of the road.

Correcting Missing-Subject Fragments

Attach to the sentence that comes before it.

The truck skidded on the rain-slick highway but missed a telephone pole on the side of the road.

Add a subject (it can be a pronoun for the subject in the preceding sentence)

She then found that her appetite was gone.

Run-Ons

There are two types of run-ons:

1. Fused sentence
2. Comma splice

Fused Sentence

A fused sentence is a sentence in which two independent clauses are joined without any punctuation separating them.

My grades are very good this semester my social life rates only C.

Comma Splice

A comma splice error occurs when sentences or independent clauses are inappropriately connected by a comma alone.

My grades are very good this semester, my social life rates only C.

Correcting Run-Ons

Use a period and a capital letter to break the two complete thoughts into separate sentences.

My grades are very good this semester. My social life rates only C.

Use a comma plus a joining word (and, but, for, or, nor, so, yet) to connect the two complete thoughts.

My grades are very good this semester, but my social life rates only C.

Correcting Run-Ons

Use a semicolon to connect the two complete thoughts.

My grades are very good this semester; my social life rates only C.

Use subordination.

Although my grades are very good this semester, my social life rates only C.